

Problem Space Mapping™ Question Index

OOF Problem Space Intelligence Index™ (PSII™)

Discovering, Structuring, and Analyzing Problem Environments and Their Root Causes

Organizations often focus on solving visible symptoms.

However, visible symptoms rarely represent the full problem.

Many operational failures, governance conflicts, responsibility disputes, compliance issues, inefficiencies, risks, and recurring challenges originate from deeper problem environments that remain poorly understood.

Problem Space Mapping™ exists to identify, structure, analyze, and understand those environments.

This Question Index™ provides a structured collection of questions designed to support problem discovery, problem classification, root-cause analysis, dependency mapping, and problem-space intelligence.

The objective is not merely to solve problems.

The objective is to understand where problems belong and why they exist.

Problem Identification

What is the problem? How is the problem described? Who identified the problem? When did the problem first appear? Is the problem recurring? Is the problem growing? Is the problem measurable? Is the problem clearly defined? Is the problem understood consistently? Does everyone agree on the problem?

Problem Scope

How large is the problem?

Who is affected? Which systems are affected? Which processes are affected? Which stakeholders are affected? Does the problem cross organizational boundaries? Does the problem cross jurisdictions? Is the problem localized or systemic? Can problem boundaries be identified? Is scope clearly understood?

Root Cause Analysis

What caused the problem? Is the visible issue the actual cause? What events contributed to the problem? Which decisions influenced the problem? Are multiple causes involved? Are root causes documented? Can root causes be verified? Are root causes recurring? Can root

causes be eliminated? Is root-cause understanding sufficient?

Problem Dependencies

What dependencies influence the problem? Does the problem depend on people? Does the problem depend on systems? Does the problem depend on governance? Does the problem depend on technology? Does the problem depend on regulation? Are dependency relationships visible? Can dependencies be mapped? Are hidden dependencies present? Do dependencies increase complexity?

Governance Problems

Does the problem involve governance failures? Are authority boundaries unclear? Are responsibilities undefined? Are accountability gaps present? Are governance controls ineffective? Are governance conflicts present? Are escalation mechanisms missing? Can governance weaknesses be identified? Are governance risks increasing? Does governance contribute to the problem?

Responsibility Problems

Who is responsible? Who is accountable? Who has authority? Who owns the outcome?

Are responsibilities documented? Are responsibilities disputed? Are responsibility gaps present? Is delegation understood? Can accountability be demonstrated? Does responsibility confusion contribute to the problem?

Operational Impact

What operational impact does the problem create? Does the problem affect performance? Does the problem affect quality? Does the problem affect safety? Does the problem affect trust? Does the problem affect decision-making? Does the problem affect efficiency? Does the problem affect compliance? Can impact be measured? Is operational impact increasing?

Risk Assessment

What risks are associated with the problem? Are risks documented? Are risks understood? Can risks be measured? Are risks increasing? Are risks systemic? Can risks be mitigated? Are emerging risks visible? Do risks affect multiple stakeholders? Is risk management sufficient?

Problem Space Classification

Which problem space does this belong to? Does the problem belong to a governance space? Does the problem belong to an operational space?

Does the problem belong to a responsibility space? Does the problem belong to a methodology space? Does the problem belong to an identity space? Does the problem belong to an infrastructure space? Can multiple spaces be involved? Is classification important? Does classification improve understanding?

Solution Readiness

Is the problem sufficiently understood? Are root causes known? Have dependencies been mapped? Have governance factors been analyzed? Have responsibility conditions been identified? Has impact been assessed? Have risks been evaluated?

Is further investigation required? Is the organization ready to act? Is the right problem being solved?

Related OOF® Service

Problem Space Mapping™

Problem Space Mapping™ helps organizations identify, structure, classify, and analyze problem environments, root causes, dependencies, governance conditions, responsibility relationships, and operational impacts before selecting solutions.

About the OOF Problem Space Intelligence Index™

The OOF Problem Space Intelligence Index™ (PSII™) is a growing collection of structured questions designed to help identify, understand, classify, and investigate problems before searching for solutions.

Questions are organized into categories, clusters, and problem environments to improve clarity, analysis, governance, and decision-making.

The objective is not merely to provide answers.

The objective is to ensure that the right questions are being asked.

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